

DANCE

OVERVIEW

In dance courses at the Grade 11 and 12 level, students continue to learn in, about, and through dance. The medium of expression is movement; the instrument is the human body. Dance education goes beyond the study of a repertoire of movements to offer an understanding of the principles and concepts that govern and define the art. Dance transforms images, ideas, and feelings into movement sequences through innovative choreographic insights. Learning in dance requires a balance of knowledge and skills, and a synergy between intellect, ability, and emotion. Engagement in dance can provide a context for understanding world issues and exploring a variety of cultures. The study and practice of composition provide students with the essential building blocks that support lifelong interest in, appreciation of, and curiosity about dance.

Students refine their kinesthetic awareness and use all of the elements of dance (body, space, time, energy, relationship) to create dance works that explore themes and express ideas and moods. Technique emphasizes the importance of physiological and safety factors while leading to a fuller use of the body and all its parts, stimulating creative and expressive abilities. Students use the elements of movement with increasing refinement, complexity, and variety. They also give attention to development of alignment, balance, correct breathing, flexibility, and strength in creating dance works and performing them safely.

The art of dance should be shared. Students develop performance skills through formal and informal presentations, helping them recognize and communicate both aesthetic and personal values. They learn about the dynamic relationship between process and product. Students also demonstrate an increased understanding of the role of dance in various cultures, societies, and historical periods. They refine their ability to evaluate the quality of performances by critiquing their own and others' work.

The expectations for courses in dance are organized into three distinct but related strands:

1. ***Creating and Presenting:*** Students use the creative process (see pages 15–17) to create, re-create, and present dance composition in a variety of contexts. Creative work in dance involves the realization of exercises, explorations, experiments, dance works, and productions through the refinement of abilities, skills, and competencies. Students demonstrate increased autonomy and innovation in their practice as both choreographer and dancer. They develop personal metaphor and demonstrate their depth of understanding of the creative process. They become increasingly familiar with the tools of stagecraft in dance presentations.

2. ***Reflecting, Responding, and Analysing:*** The critical analysis process (see pages 17–22) involves applying rational and logical thinking to learning in, about, and through dance. Students demonstrate increasing autonomy and ability of all stages of the critical analysis process. They evaluate their own dance work and the work of others, reflect on how dance can enhance both personal well-being and community life, investigate artistic and social influences on dance, and explore possibilities for continuing engagement in dance.
3. ***Foundations:*** This strand encompasses the body of knowledge, understanding, concepts, conventions, and norms that create an underpinning and a context for dance as an arts discipline. Understanding how to move the human body and expanding its movement vocabulary helps students develop insight into how and why people dance. Students examine developments in dance history and dance conventions around the world. At the same time, they expand their awareness of the artistic environment with respect to matters of safety, ethics, and acceptable modes of conduct as an artist, performer, and critic.

For policy guidelines pertaining to focus courses, see pages 12–13 of this document.
The list of approved focus courses for Dance can be found at:
www.edu.gov.on.ca/eng/curriculum/secondary/arts.html.

Dance, Grade 12

University/College Preparation

ATC4M

This course emphasizes the development of students' technical proficiency, fluency in the language of movement in dance genres from around the world, and understanding of dance science. Students will explain the social, cultural, and historical contexts of dance; apply the creative process through the art of dance in a variety of ways; and exhibit an understanding of the purpose and possibilities of continuing engagement in the arts as a lifelong learner.

Prerequisite: Dance, Grade 11, University/College Preparation

A. CREATING, PRESENTING, AND PERFORMING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- A1. The Creative Process:** use the creative process, the elements of dance, and a variety of sources to develop movement vocabulary;
- A2. Choreography and Composition:** combine the elements of dance in a variety of ways in composing individual and ensemble dance creations;
- A3. Dance Techniques:** demonstrate an understanding of the dance techniques and movement vocabularies of a variety of dance forms from around the world;
- A4. Performance:** apply dance presentation skills in a variety of contexts and performances.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

A1. The Creative Process

By the end of this course, students will:

- A1.1** use the elements of dance to create and perform abstract dance phrases inspired by a theme of personal significance (*e.g., a theme suggested by an environmental or social issue or by a composition of a favourite dance group*)

Teacher prompt: “What does a dance film like *Sarah* by Kaeja d’Dance tell you about the creative process? Can you use a similar type of process when working thematically to develop your own movement phrases?”

- A1.2** create and perform complex phrases that combine and manipulate the elements of dance in a variety of ways (*e.g., generate dance vocabulary using variations and mixtures of different aspects of the elements, such as body actions, locomotor steps, direction, level, floor and air patterns, structured and unstructured space, symmetry and asymmetry, individual and group shapes, tempo, accent, movement qualities, relationships/groupings*)

Teacher prompt: “If you choose to focus on non-locomotor body actions, how might that affect the way you incorporate other elements – such as time, space, and relationship – into your dance phrases?”

- A1.3** use the elements of dance to generate and perform complex dance vocabulary through solo or ensemble improvisation and experimentation (*e.g., in pairs, use action/reaction during contact improvisation to explore movement possibilities*)

Teacher prompt: “How does improvisation extend your understanding of movement possibilities? How will you use this new understanding in your dance composition?”

- A1.4** generate and develop solutions for a complex compositional problem and demonstrate one solution in performance (*e.g., in a small group, create a movement problem/recipe for another group to solve, and develop and demonstrate a solution to a movement problem created by the other group*)

Teacher prompt: “What insights into the creative process can you gain from creating a movement problem for others to solve? What insights can you gain from the solutions they develop?”

A2. Choreography and Composition

By the end of this course, students will:

- A2.1** use a variety of choreographic forms, structures, and techniques to create and perform complex dance works (*e.g., in pairs, use ABACA [rondo] form as a basis for an original composition*)

Teacher prompt: “How can you decide which form or techniques are most suitable for your work? How do you decide if a technique is effective? What role does viewing work by your peers play in assessing and revising your own work?”

A2.2 create a complex dance composition that explores an abstract theme (*e.g., explore the theme of the transformative power of dance in the context of conflict in a composition that pays tribute to the Ugandan refugee children featured in the film War Dance by Albie Hecht*)

Teacher prompt: “What concrete movements and choreographic structures can you use to illustrate the abstract idea you want to express?”

A2.3 use a variety of compositional approaches in developing dance creations that explore complex, challenging themes and moods (*e.g., identify and use several compositional approaches, such as theme and variation or a specific movement repertoire, that will help them explore multiple dimensions of a theme; identify a compositional approach used by an Ontario choreographer whose work they admire, and adapt the approach to their own process of dance creation*)

Teacher prompt: “When you create dances, some of what you do is based on intuition and some is based on the repertoire of compositional forms and approaches you have learned in your dance studies. How will you achieve a balance between the two types of influences?”

A3. Dance Techniques

By the end of this course, students will:

A3.1 apply an understanding of a wide range of movement vocabularies found in a variety of dance forms from around the world (*e.g., accurately perform a large repertoire of movements from ballet/jazz dance, modern/contemporary dance, and two or more world dance forms such as flamenco, gumboot dancing, and belly dancing*)

Teacher prompts: “How does training in a variety of dance forms expand your awareness of the possible positions and movements of different parts of your body (your kinesthetic range)?” “What types of movements do many dances share? What types of differences between dances do you find interesting, and why?”

A3.2 accurately demonstrate a wide range of movement techniques from a variety of dance forms from around the world (*e.g., correctly perform assigned phrases that alternate the use of weighted movement and movement requiring a weightless quality*)

Teacher prompt: “When nuance is added to a movement, what happens to the dynamic quality (speed or pace) of the phrase it is part of? Could it make the movement more difficult to perform? In what way? How might it look to an audience?”

A3.3 create and perform compositions that blend the vocabulary and technique of Western and non-Western dance forms (*e.g., salsa and breakdance*)

Teacher prompt: “What style of music do you think would support your ‘fusion’ choreography? Why would it be a good choice? What other style of music might also be appropriate? Why?”

A4. Performance

By the end of this course, students will:

A4.1 revise, refine, and polish movement execution and choreography, with particular attention to how each detail contributes to the whole and to the intended effect (*e.g., use their own intuitions and analyses and feedback from peers and the teacher to rework, clarify, and perfect individual movements, phrases, transitions, and sequences*)

Teacher prompt: “What skills do you use when revising and polishing your work? How are they the same as or different from the skills you use at the start of the creative process?”

A4.2 use a variety of tools of stagecraft in increasingly complex or imaginative ways to enhance their dance performances (*e.g., locate and use choreographic software and electronic technology to assist the process of creation and presentation; use music editing software to adapt a piece of music to their own choreography; use digital videography to create their own filmed interpretations of their choreography*)

Teacher prompt: “What technologies could you use to help in the creation and production processes and enhance the effectiveness of your presentation?”

A4.3 demonstrate both an intellectual and an emotional understanding of the artistic and expressive intent of a work in rehearsals and performances (*e.g., explain the artistic intention of their dance piece in a written “artist’s statement”; maintain their focus on the relationship between their movements and the intended meaning of a piece*)

Teacher prompt: “What is the artistic intent of your dance piece, and how is it expressed in your dancing/choreography?”

B. REFLECTING, RESPONDING, AND ANALYSING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1. The Critical Analysis Process:** use the critical analysis process to reflect on and evaluate their own and others' dance works and activities;
- B2. Dance and Society:** demonstrate an understanding of how societies present and past use or have used dance, and of how creating and viewing dance can benefit individuals, groups, and communities;
- B3. Connections Beyond the Classroom:** demonstrate an understanding of the purpose and possibilities of continuing engagement in dance arts.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

B1. The Critical Analysis Process

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1.1** critique a live or filmed work by an Ontario dance artist (e.g., use a set of aesthetic evaluative criteria established in class to review works by Ontario dance artists such as Laura Taler, Jenn Goodwin, Allen Kaeja, Lata Pada)

Teacher prompt: "How does having a pre-established set of criteria in mind influence the way you view a dance work? Does it help you notice things you might miss? Could it limit your response in any way?"

- B1.2** develop appropriate criteria and use them to interpret, analyse, and evaluate both the content and the fluency or expressiveness of a broad range of student compositions (e.g., criteria such as use of props, dynamics, interpretive skills)

Teacher prompts: "What is the purpose of integrating a prop into this composition? How might props affect the impact of a performance?" "Is the symbolic meaning of the steps and gestures used in the work clear or hard to understand?"

B2. Dance and Society

By the end of this course, students will:

- B2.1** identify a variety of world and social dance forms in Ontario and describe their contribution to economic, social, and cultural life (e.g., the role of Sampradaya Dance Creations in raising the profile of South Asian dance in the province)

Teacher prompt: "What impact did Lata Pada's bharatanatyam dance company have on the dance community in Toronto after its founding in 1990?"

- B2.2** identify specific ways in which dance education can enhance community life (e.g., develop a brochure about how dance education could benefit their local community)

Teacher prompt: "What groups in our community might benefit from viewing or participating in dance? Seniors? Young children? How could you help these groups learn more about opportunities to watch or join in dance activities?"

- B2.3** compare and contrast criteria used to evaluate dance in different cultures (e.g., identify similarities and differences in the aesthetic criteria applied to a Western prima ballerina and a renowned Middle Eastern belly dancer)

Teacher prompt: "What cultural influences have shaped the standards of excellence that are applied to these different types of dance?"

B3. Connections Beyond the Classroom

By the end of this course, students will:

- B3.1** identify and describe a variety of postsecondary destinations in the field of dance and the training or education required for each (e.g., occupations in dance arts advocacy, administration, creation, design and production, education, fund-raising, performance, staging)

Teacher prompt: “What postsecondary institution(s) provide instruction in dance notation? What were some of the career options and choices made by individuals who have embarked on that career?”

B3.2 develop and implement a plan for improving the climate for dance education within their school community (*e.g., use a survey to discover how dance arts are perceived within the school, and plan and carry out a campaign to enhance the image of dance studies among teachers and students*)

Teacher prompt: “What specifically would you like the members of the school community to

know about the art of dance? How can you effectively communicate this information to all members of the school community?”

B3.3 develop a traditional or digital dance portfolio for a specific audience and purpose (*e.g., to serve as a resource for junior dance classes*)

Teacher prompt: “How should your information be organized and displayed when it is to be used as a resource by other students? What information should be communicated first, and how do you decide what information should follow? How important are accuracy and clarity when communicating information in this manner?”

C. FOUNDATIONS

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1. Physiology and Terminology:** demonstrate an understanding of, and use correct terminology when referring to, the physiology of movement as it relates to dance;
- C2. Contexts and Influences:** demonstrate an understanding of the social, cultural, and historical origins and development of dance forms, including their influence on each other and on society;
- C3. Responsible Practices:** demonstrate an understanding of safe, ethical, and responsible personal and interpersonal practices in dance activities.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

C1. Physiology and Terminology

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1.1** identify and demonstrate an understanding of somatic techniques that enhance dance training and physical and emotional well-being (*e.g., maintain a record of their use and the effects of techniques such as yoga, Pilates, the Alexander Technique, the Feldenkrais Method, Joan Skinner's Releasing Technique, Donna Krasnow's C-I [conditioning-with-imagery] Training*)

Teacher prompts: "What significant improvement in your physical condition or development have you noticed? What techniques have you found most helpful?" "Has your study of Pilates strengthened your core, and what has that core strength done to improve your centre of balance in locomotion?"

- C1.2** analyse and explain movement patterns using correct biomechanical terminology (*e.g., use a graphic to explain the biomechanics of a variety of movements in the frontal, medial, horizontal, and sagittal planes*)

Teacher prompt: "Identify at least five dance exercises or movements that occur in each plane. What other movements from daily life (such as walking, sitting, texting, hugging) occur in each of these biomechanical planes?"

- C1.3** demonstrate, and describe using correct terminology, an extensive dance vocabulary from a variety of dance forms from around

the world (*e.g., describe and demonstrate ballet movements such as pas de basque, contretemps, pas de ciseaux, temps de cuisse; use print and electronic media to develop an illustrated dictionary describing the movement vocabulary of a dance style of their choice for younger students*)

Teacher prompt: "Based on the format of dictionaries you have examined, what components do you need to include in each definition? What are some terms that are common to many or most dance styles?"

C2. Contexts and Influences

By the end of this course, students will:

- C2.1** demonstrate an understanding of key developments in Ontario dance history, including the artistic contributions of Ontario dance pioneers (*e.g., the founding and development of companies such as the Toronto Dance Theatre or Dance Theatre David Earle; the work of dancer-choreographers such as Celia Franca, George Randolph, Zelma Badu*)

Teacher prompt: "Who were the key innovators in David Earle's dance company in the early years? What factors shaped its growth? What are its goals today?" "Who were the first artistic directors of the National Ballet of Canada? How did their dance experience influence the company's direction and growth?"

C2.2 describe the influence of global artistic, social, and political events or issues (*e.g., globalization, the environment, poverty, HIV/AIDS, war, political repression, refugees*) on the current Canadian arts scene, including but not limited to the dance scene

Teacher prompt: “How have Canadian choreographers used dance to raise public awareness of an important social or environmental issue?”

C2.3 identify, describe, and compare how a variety of elements and conventions of dance are used in a selection of dance genres from around the world, and demonstrate their findings through performance (*e.g., demonstrate the uses of the circle or explain the function of music in different dance genres; create a digital media presentation to illustrate various dance dress codes*)

Teacher prompt: “What is the purpose of the group dancing of a Broadway chorus line and a traditional Russian folk dance? What similarities and differences can you identify between the two types of group dancing?”

C3. Responsible Practices

By the end of this course, students will:

C3.1 model responsible, constructive behaviour in interactions with others during the creation and production processes (*e.g., work cooperatively to solve problems and resolve conflicts peacefully; mentor a younger dance student to help develop his or her understanding of appropriate behaviour in rehearsal and performance*)

Teacher prompt: “Do you notice a change in the behaviour of your mentee? How does acting as a mentor affect your own understanding of appropriate performance behaviour?”

C3.2 demonstrate leadership skills during the creation and production processes (*e.g., participate in a leadership outreach experience to produce dance pieces for younger dancers to perform at a school Arts Night or other school/community event*)

Teacher prompts: “What are the attributes of an effective leader?” “What leadership opportunities can you identify related to dance activities in your school and local community?”

C3.3 model safe and ethical practices in dance activities in both classroom and performance settings (*e.g., learn and apply procedures for the safe and appropriate use of equipment in studios, classrooms, rehearsal and performance spaces, and alternative venues; use environmentally friendly materials and processes in dance productions; acknowledge sources and comply with laws, regulations, and customary practices for the protection of choreographic, intellectual, and creative property rights*)

Teacher prompts: “What steps can experienced dancers take to help raise awareness among younger students of appropriate safety practices in performance environments?” “What procedures should we follow when preparing the costumes, sets, and performance venue to ensure the environmentally responsible use of materials and energy?” “How can you build on others’ experience while avoiding improper use of sources and influences?”